

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD _____

7-0 (A)

Rcd 12/8/00 upl

Species: Great Black-backed Gull (*Larus marinus*)**Date:** 15 October & 12 November 2000 **Number seen:** one **Sex:** ? **Plumage:** Def. Basic**Locality:** Cherry Creek Res.**Elevation:** about 5350'**Nearest town:** Aurora**County:** Arapahoe**Time observed:** 11:00-11:10 (on 10/15); 9:50-9:55 (11/12)**Duration of observation:** about 15 minutes**Description:** I was able to see the returning Great Black-backed Gull (GBBG) twice during fall 2000. On 10/15, it was perched on one of the booms at the marina; on 11/12, it was perched on a small, rarely-seen island just to the east of the marina.

The gull was much, much larger than the California (CAGU) and Herring gulls nearby. Its head was white with thin, brown streaking that was visible only at close range. The bill was large and yellow with a large, red gonydeal spot. The eyes were small (the size of the eyes of a nearby CAGU, despite this bird's much larger size) and were just barely discernible as yellow at close range. The mantle and wings were dark, dark gray (almost black) and only contrasted a little with the black primary tips. The legs were very dull grayish-pink. The P10 mirror extended all the way to the feather tip creating a very large white tip. The underparts were white, as was the tail. The bird had wide, white tertial crescents. The scapular crescents were not discernible. On 10/15, the inner primaries were newly-replaced and P8-10 were old. I did not determine the bird's state of molt in November.

Similar species eliminated: Lesser Black-backed is eliminated by head pattern and coloration, size, and bill size. Slaty-backed Gull is also eliminated by size and by leg color. Kelp Gull is ruled out on leg color and head pattern. Western Gull is eliminated by coloration.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): No vocalizations heard.**What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species?** I had seen >80 *gracillii* LBBGs, 10s of 1000s of GBBGs, about 50 Slaty-backed. I have not seen Kelp Gull.**Light conditions:** sun was to my right**Optical equipment used:** Leica 20-60x**Distance, and how estimated:** estimated closest approach at about 100 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Doug Faulkner (10/15) and Larry Semo and Michael Patten (11/12)

Other observers who saw the bird independently: numerous, during the bird's long annual stay (but, how many will submit documentation??)

If photographed, type of equipment and film: I did not photograph the bird.

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none **b) after observation:** none

Reporting observer: Tony Leukering

Signature: 

Address: Colorado Bird Observatory, 13401 Picadilly Road, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: 5 December 2000 from notes written during the observation on 15 October 2000